STANDARD OPERATING PROCEDURE

New User Registration & Ticket Creation

SQL Server DBA Job Support | DBASupport Portal

Document Title	New User Registration and Ticket Creation SOP
Portal	DBASupport Portal (Zoho Desk)
Applies To	New and registered support users
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Classification	Internal / User Guidance
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1. Purpose

This Standard Operating Procedure (SOP) explains how new users register in the SQL DBA Job Support portal and raise support tickets. It covers registration, login, ticket creation, ticket formatting, follow-up, status interpretation, escalation, and closure.

The scope of support includes SQL Server DBA job support, production troubleshooting, performance tuning, interview support, real-time guidance, and general technical assistance.

2. Portal Name

DBASupport Portal

3. Portal Access

Open the SQL DBA Support registration portal using the link below:

> **Registration URL**
> `https://sqldbasupport.zohodesk.com/portal/en/signup`

4. Who Should Register

New users should register if they need support for any of the following:

- SQL Server DBA job support
- Production issue troubleshooting
- SQL Server performance tuning help
- Backup and restore issues
- Always On, Log Shipping, Replication, or Clustering support
- SQL Server migration support
- Azure SQL DB or Azure SQL Managed Instance support
- Interview preparation support
- Real-time SQL DBA guidance
- Script review or troubleshooting assistance

5. New User Registration Process

Step 1. Open the registration portal.

Step 2. Enter the required user details, such as name, email address, and password.

Step 3. Use a valid email address, because all ticket updates and support communication are sent to this address.

Step 4. Complete the signup process.

Step 5. Check your email inbox for any verification or activation email.

Step 6. If email verification is required, open the verification email and activate your account.

Step 7. After successful registration, log in to the portal using your registered email address and password.

6. Login Process for Registered Users

Step 8. Open the DBASupport portal.

Step 9. Click Sign In or Login.

Step 10. Enter your registered email address.

Step 11. Enter your password.

Step 12. Click Sign In.

Step 13. After login, verify that you can access the customer portal dashboard.

7. How to Raise a SQL DBA Support Ticket

Step 14. Log in to the DBASupport portal.

Step 15. Click the option to submit, create, or raise a ticket.

Step 16. Select the appropriate department or category if shown.

Step 17. Enter a clear ticket subject (example: SQL Server Always On Database Not Synchronizing).

Step 18. Enter a detailed description of the issue.

The ticket description should include:

- Issue summary
- Server name or environment type
- SQL Server version
- Database name, if applicable
- Error message
- When the issue started
- Business impact
- Steps already tried
- Screenshots, if available
- Scripts or logs, if available

Step 19. Select the correct priority (see the priority guideline below).

Step 20. Attach screenshots, error logs, execution plans, scripts, or documents if required.

Step 21. Review all entered information.

Step 22. Click Submit.

Step 23. Note the ticket number generated by the portal.

Priority Guideline

Priority	When to Use
Low	General question, learning support, documentation request
Medium	Non-urgent issue, script review, interview preparation
High	Job support issue affecting work delivery
Critical	Production issue, outage, blocking, database down, backup failure, Always On failure, or urgent client-side issue

8. Recommended Ticket Format

Use the format below when raising a ticket:

```
Issue Title:
Environment:        Production / UAT / Dev / Lab
SQL Server Version:
Database Name:
Issue Start Time:
Error Message:
Business Impact:
Steps Already Tried:
Support Needed:
Attachments Added:  Yes / No
```

9. Example Ticket

```
Issue Title:        SQL Server Backup Job Failed
Environment:        Production
SQL Server Version: SQL Server 2019
Database Name:      SalesDB
Issue Start Time:   Today at 2:00 AM CST
Error Message:      Backup failed because the disk is full.
Business Impact:    Daily full backup did not complete.
Steps Already Tried: Checked SQL Agent job history and
                     verified backup path.
Support Needed:     Identify the root cause and fix the
                     backup job failure.
Attachments Added:  SQL Agent job error screenshot and
                     backup job script.
```

10. Ticket Follow-Up Process

Step 24. After submitting the ticket, monitor your registered email for updates.

Step 25. Log in to the portal to check ticket status.

Step 26. Reply inside the same ticket instead of creating duplicate tickets for the same issue.

Step 27. If the support team requests additional details, provide the required screenshots, logs, or scripts.

Step 28. If the issue becomes urgent, update the ticket with the latest impact and request a priority review.

11. Ticket Status Meaning

Status	Meaning
Open	Ticket has been submitted and is waiting for review.
In Progress	Support team is working on the issue.
Waiting for User	More information is required from the user.
Resolved	Support team has provided a solution.
Closed	Ticket is completed and closed.

12. Best Practices for Faster Support

Do

- Provide complete error messages.
- Explain the context — do not send only screenshots.
- State whether the issue is Production, UAT, Development, or Lab.
- Attach SQL scripts, job history, logs, and screenshots when possible.
- Mention the exact SQL Server version.
- State whether this is urgent job support or general learning support.
- Create one ticket per issue and use clear subject lines.

Avoid

- Do not create multiple duplicate tickets for the same problem.
- Do not send screenshots without any explanation.
- Do not omit the environment type or SQL Server version.

13. Common SQL DBA Ticket Categories

Category	Category
Backup and Restore	Security and Permissions
Performance Tuning	SQL Agent Jobs
Blocking and Deadlocks	Database Corruption
Always On Availability Groups	Index Maintenance
Log Shipping	Query Troubleshooting
Replication	Interview Preparation
SQL Server Installation	Real-Time Job Support
SQL Server Migration	Azure SQL Managed Instance

Category	Category
Azure SQL DB	—

14. Escalation Guidelines

Mark a ticket as Critical only when there is a production outage or urgent business impact.

Examples of Critical Issues

- SQL Server service is down.
- Production database is unavailable.
- Always On primary replica issue.
- Backup failure for a critical database.
- Severe blocking impacting the business.
- Disk-full issue on a production server.
- Application unable to connect to SQL Server.

For non-production learning or interview questions, use Low or Medium priority.

15. Closure Process

Step 29. Once the issue is fixed, review the support response.

Step 30. Validate the solution in your environment.

Step 31. Confirm in the ticket that the issue is resolved.

Step 32. If the same issue reoccurs, reopen the ticket if the portal allows it, or create a new ticket and reference the previous ticket number.

16. User Responsibility

Users are responsible for providing accurate issue details, screenshots, logs, and environment information.

Users must not share confidential passwords, production credentials, private keys, or sensitive client data in a ticket. If credentials are required for live support, use a secure, approved method rather than pasting passwords into the ticket.

17. Security Note

Never Share the Following in a Ticket

- SQL Server admin passwords
- Windows server passwords
- Azure portal passwords
- VPN credentials
- Customer-sensitive data
- Production personally identifiable information (PII)
- Client confidential documents

Mask sensitive details before uploading screenshots or logs.

18. Summary

New users must register through the DBASupport portal, verify their email if required, log in, and raise a ticket with complete SQL DBA issue details. Clear, well-structured ticket information helps the support team understand the problem quickly and provide accurate SQL Server DBA job support.